Validation Reliance Eligibility & Sufficiency Module (VRESM)

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Governed Space

Validation Reliance Eligibility & Sufficiency

Canonical Definition

Validation Reliance Eligibility & Sufficiency Module (VRESM) defines the governance framework for determining whether a current Validation State provides a sufficiently applicable, current, bounded, and proportionate validation basis for a specific Relying Actor to rely upon a Validation Object for a defined purpose, scope, context, consequence level, duration, and operational use.

It establishes the first reliance-governance gate between:

an object possessing a Validation State

and:

that Validation State being legitimately usable as a basis for reliance.

Operational Role

VRESM serves as the first internal governance space of the
Validation Reliance & Revalidation Standard (VRRS).

The ninth Parent Standard, VSGS, establishes:

What Validation State does the Validation Object currently hold?

VRESM asks the next question:

Is that current Validation State actually sufficient for this specific reliance?

The governed progression begins:

Current Validation State → Relying Actor → Reliance Purpose → Reliance Scope → Reliance Context → Consequence → Applicability Match → Sufficiency Assessment → Reliance Eligibility Status

VRESM does not itself authorize reliance.

It establishes whether the validation basis is methodologically sufficient to support consideration of reliance.

Core Distinction

VALIDOS® establishes:

Validation State ≠ Reliance Eligibility

and:

Reliance Eligibility ≠ Reliance Authorization

These represent three separate governance questions:

Validation State

What validation condition does the object hold?

Reliance Eligibility

Can that validation condition sufficiently support this intended reliance?

Reliance Authorization

Is the actor permitted to rely upon it?

VRESM governs the second question.

Module Operational Space

VRESM governs:

- Relying Actor identification,
- Reliance Purpose,

- Reliance Scope,
- Reliance Context,
- Reliance Consequence,
- Reliance Criticality,
- Validation State applicability matching,
- object-version matching,
- purpose matching,
- scope matching,
- population matching,
- environment matching,
- jurisdiction matching,
- operational-mode matching,
- autonomy-level matching,
- consequence matching,
- Validation Depth sufficiency,
- evidence sufficiency for reliance,
- Source Reliability relevance,
- uncertainty sufficiency,
- condition compatibility,
- restriction compatibility,
- limitation awareness,
- Validation State currency,
- expiration awareness,
- revalidation-status awareness,
- reliance eligibility,
- reliance conditional eligibility,
- partial reliance eligibility,
- reliance insufficiency,
- and eligibility uncertainty.

Relying Actor Identification

A reliance assessment should identify who or what intends to rely upon the Validation State.

A Relying Actor may be:

- a person,
- organization,
- institution,
- regulator,
- AI system,
- autonomous agent,
- software system,
- decision engine,
- operational process,
- infrastructure,
- or another governed entity.

Reliance cannot be fully assessed in abstraction from the actor using the validation basis.

Relying Actor Context

Relevant actor characteristics may include:

- operational role,
- intended authority,
- technical capability,
- jurisdiction,
- responsibility,
- dependency level,
- oversight structure,
- and consequence exposure.

VRESM does not determine whether the actor possesses legal or organizational authority.

It identifies the actor so validation sufficiency can be assessed within the correct context.

Reliance Purpose

Every reliance assessment should establish:

Why is the Validation State being relied upon?

Possible purposes include:

- informational use,
- research,
- recommendation,
- advisory support,
- decision support,
- automated decision,
- autonomous execution,
- safety assurance,
- operational control,
- deployment dependency,
- regulatory assessment,
- medical use,
- financial use,
- or another governed purpose.

Purpose Match

The intended Reliance Purpose should be compared with the purpose under which the Validation Object was validated.

Possible results include:

Purpose Match

Purpose Partial Match

Purpose Mismatch

or:

Purpose Match Undetermined

A mismatch may materially limit reliance eligibility.

Purpose Expansion

Purpose Expansion occurs where the proposed reliance goes beyond the purpose supported by the current Validation State.

For example:

Validated Purpose: Advisory Support

Proposed Reliance Purpose: Autonomous Execution

This is not merely a new use label.

It may represent a materially different validation requirement.

Reliance Scope

Reliance Scope defines the boundary within which the Relying Actor intends to use the validation basis.

Scope may include:

- function,
- task,
- output,
- population,
- environment,
- jurisdiction,
- object version,
- configuration,
- operational mode,
- autonomy level,
- time period,
- decision class,
- or consequence domain.

Scope Match

VRESM compares the proposed Reliance Scope with the current State Applicability Profile.

Possible outcomes include:

Full Scope Match

Partial Scope Match

Scope Exceeds Validation

Scope Mismatch

or:

Scope Match Undetermined

Reliance Scope Principle

VALIDOS® establishes:

Reliance Scope ≤ Validation State Applicability

Reliance may intentionally be narrower than validation.

It should not silently become broader.

Partial Scope Eligibility

Where only part of the proposed Reliance Scope falls within validated applicability, VRESM may establish:

Reliance Partially Eligible

The eligible and ineligible portions should remain distinguishable.

Object Identity Match

Before reliance eligibility can be established, the relied-upon Validation State must correspond to the actual object being used.

VRESM therefore checks: **Validated Object = Relied-Upon Object?**

This may require comparison of:

- object identity,
- version,
- configuration,
- model,
- component set,
- deployment form,
- or other identity-relevant characteristics.

Object Version Match

A Validation State for:

Version 4.2

does not automatically support reliance upon:

Version 5.0

Version equivalence must be established where required.

Configuration Match

Even identical nominal versions may operate under materially different configurations.

Reliance eligibility may therefore depend upon:

- enabled features,
- tool access,
- safety controls,
- model settings,
- permissions,
- autonomy settings,
- external integrations,
- or other configuration characteristics.

Population Match

Where validation applies to a population, VRESM compares the intended reliance population with the validated population.

Possible conditions include:

Population Match

Population Partially Covered

Population Outside Validation

or:

Population Applicability Undetermined

Environment Match

A Validation State may depend upon operating environment.

Environment matching may consider:

- physical environment,
- infrastructure,
- network conditions,
- deployment context,
- language,
- geography,
- user setting,
- or surrounding systems.

Jurisdiction Match

Where jurisdiction affects validation applicability, VRESM identifies whether the proposed reliance occurs within the validated jurisdictional scope.

This does not determine legal compliance.

It preserves validation-scope boundaries.

Operational Mode Match

A system may possess different operational modes.

For example:

Manual

Assisted

Semi-Autonomous

Autonomous

Validation in one mode should not automatically establish reliance eligibility in another.

Autonomy-Level Match

Autonomy can materially alter reliance consequence.

VRESM therefore checks whether the intended autonomy level falls within the Validation State applicability.

Reliance Context

Reliance Context describes the operational circumstances surrounding the intended reliance.

It may include:

- who relies,
- why,
- where,
- when,
- upon which object version,
- with which oversight,
- with what reversibility,
- at what scale,
- and with what consequence.

Context Match

Validation should not be assumed transferable across materially different contexts.

Possible outcomes include:

Context Sufficiently Matched

Context Conditionally Matched

Context Partially Matched

Context Materially Mismatched

or:

Context Match Undetermined

Reliance Consequence

Reliance Consequence represents the potential significance of an incorrect, incomplete, misleading, outdated, or otherwise insufficient Validation Object when relied upon.

Possible consequence dimensions include:

- safety,
- health,
- financial exposure,
- legal rights,
- infrastructure,
- autonomy,
- security,
- operational continuity,
- social impact,
- or another material domain.

Consequence Does Not Equal Risk

VRESM does not replace RIS™.

Its purpose is narrower.

It asks:

Is the validation assurance proportionate to the consequence of this intended reliance?

Reliance Criticality

A Reliance Context may be classified according to its operational criticality.

An implementation may use categories such as:

Low Reliance Criticality

Moderate Reliance Criticality

High Reliance Criticality

Critical Reliance or another governed classification.

The classification system should remain explicit and domain-appropriate.

Critical Reliance

Critical Reliance exists where failure of the validation basis could materially affect:

- life,
- health,
- major financial exposure,
- critical infrastructure,
- autonomous physical action,
- fundamental rights,
- or another high-consequence domain.

Critical Reliance may require stronger validation assurance.

Validation Depth Sufficiency

A Validation State may be applicable but still insufficiently deep for the intended Reliance Context.

VRESM therefore evaluates:

Is the Validation Depth proportionate to the reliance consequence?

For example:

A lightweight validation may support low-consequence internal experimentation.

The same Validation Depth may be insufficient for autonomous medical or industrial control.

Validation Depth Escalation

Where the proposed reliance consequence exceeds the assurance level supported by existing validation, VRESM may identify:

Validation Depth Escalation Required

This can later become a revalidation input.

Evidence Sufficiency for Reliance

Evidence may have been sufficient to establish a particular Validation State while still being insufficient for a more consequential reliance.

VRESM may therefore consider whether the evidence basis adequately supports the intended Reliance Context.

Source Reliability Relevance

Reliance may depend heavily upon certain validation sources.

Where a high-consequence reliance depends upon weak, uncertain, indirect, or outdated sources, eligibility may require additional assurance.

VRESM consumes Source Reliability information rather than duplicating the sixth Parent Standard.

Uncertainty Sufficiency

Every validation contains some uncertainty.

VRESM asks whether that uncertainty remains acceptable for the intended reliance from a validation-sufficiency perspective.

Possible outcomes may include:

Uncertainty Compatible with Reliance

Uncertainty Requires Conditions

Uncertainty Too High for Reliance

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or:

Uncertainty Sufficiency Undetermined

This does not replace formal risk acceptance.

Validation State Currency

Reliance eligibility requires a current validation basis.

VRESM therefore checks whether the Validation State is:

- current,
- expired,
- suspended,
- superseded,
- invalidated,
- under Revalidation Required,
- or otherwise lifecycle-limited.

Expired Validation

A historical:

Validated

state does not establish current reliance eligibility after:

Validation Expired

unless another governed basis explicitly permits limited reliance.

Suspended Validation

A Validation Suspended state normally creates a strong reliance restriction.

Where continued limited reliance is methodologically possible, the allowed scope must be explicit.

Revalidation Required

Where the current state is:

Revalidation Required VRESM should not silently treat the previous Validated state as fully current.

The reliance assessment must account for the revalidation requirement.

State Applicability Match

The State Applicability Profile established by VSGS becomes a core VRESM input.

VRESM compares:

Validated Applicability

against:

Intended Reliance Reality

The comparison may include:

- object,
- version,
- function,
- population,
- environment,
- jurisdiction,
- mode,
- autonomy,
- time,
- conditions,
- restrictions,
- and limitations.

Condition Compatibility

A reliance context must be capable of satisfying mandatory Validation State conditions.

For example:

Validation Condition: Human Oversight Required

If the proposed reliance removes human oversight, the condition is not compatible.

Possible outcomes include:

Conditions Satisfied

Conditions Satisfiable

Conditions Partially Satisfied

Conditions Not Satisfied

or:

Condition Status Undetermined

Restriction Compatibility

Restrictions are treated as hard validation boundaries unless later governance legitimately changes them.

For example:

Not Validated for Autonomous Execution should prevent reliance eligibility for autonomous execution.

Limitation Awareness

Limitations may not automatically prohibit reliance.

However, they must remain visible in the sufficiency assessment.

A limitation may become material depending upon:

- consequence,
- purpose,
- context,
- scale,
- or dependency.

Reliance Sufficiency

Reliance Sufficiency is the degree to which the current Validation State and its supporting validation basis adequately support the intended Reliance Context.

It is not a universal property of the Validation Object.

It is relational:

Validation State ↔ Reliance Context

Reliance Sufficiency Dimensions

A Reliance Sufficiency Assessment may consider:

Object Sufficiency

Is the correct Validation Object being relied upon?

State Sufficiency

Is the Validation State current and appropriate?

Purpose Sufficiency

Does validation support the intended purpose?

Scope Sufficiency

Does validation cover the intended scope?

Context Sufficiency

Does the operational context remain compatible?

Depth Sufficiency

Is Validation Depth proportionate to consequence?

Evidence Sufficiency Is the evidence basis adequate for this reliance?

Source Sufficiency

Are material validation sources sufficiently reliable?

Condition Sufficiency

Can required conditions be satisfied?

Uncertainty Sufficiency

Is remaining validation uncertainty compatible with the reliance context?

Reliance Sufficiency Profile

VRESM may generate a **Reliance Sufficiency Profile** combining the relevant dimensions without reducing them prematurely to one opaque score.

For example:

Object Match: Full

Purpose Match: Full

Scope Match: Partial

Context Match: Full

Validation Depth: Insufficient

Conditions: Satisfied

State Currency: Current

Overall Reliance Sufficiency: Insufficient

This preserves explainability.

No Compensation by Unrelated Strength

VALIDOS® establishes:

Strength in one reliance dimension does not automatically compensate for a critical failure in another.

Extremely strong evidence cannot make an out-of-scope population automatically validated.

Perfect object identity cannot compensate for an expired Validation State.

High Validation Depth cannot eliminate a mandatory-condition failure.

Critical Reliance Deficiency

A **Critical Reliance Deficiency** exists where a missing or failed requirement independently prevents legitimate reliance.

Examples include:

- wrong Validation Object,
- materially incompatible version,
- intended use explicitly excluded,
- expired critical validation,
- mandatory condition absent,
- Validation State Invalidated,
- or critical scope mismatch.

Reliance Eligibility Status

Following sufficiency assessment, VRESM may assign:

Reliance Eligible

The current Validation State provides a sufficiently applicable validation basis for the intended Reliance Context.

Reliance Conditionally Eligible

The validation basis is sufficient only if explicit conditions are satisfied.

Reliance Partially Eligible

Only a defined portion of the proposed reliance is sufficiently supported.

Reliance Eligibility Undetermined

Available information is insufficient to establish eligibility.

Reliance Not Eligible

The current validation basis does not sufficiently support the intended reliance.

Eligibility Is Context-Bound

An Eligibility Status applies only to the assessed:

- Relying Actor,
- Validation Object,
- purpose,
- scope,
- context,
- consequence,
- time,
- and conditions.

It should not be generalized automatically.

Eligibility Is Time-Bound

A Reliance Eligible determination may later become obsolete if:

- Validation State changes,
- object changes,
- conditions fail,
- reliance context changes,
- validation expires,
- or new evidence emerges.

Eligibility therefore belongs to the lifecycle rather than being a permanent property.

Eligibility Reassessment Trigger

VRESM may identify triggers requiring reassessment, including:

- Validation State transition,
- object version change,
- configuration change,
- Reliance Purpose change,

- scope expansion,
- consequence escalation,
- population change,
- environment change,
- autonomy increase,
- condition failure,
- or revalidation requirement.

Reliance Eligibility Does Not Override Validation

VRESM cannot make an invalid Validation State valid.

It consumes upstream validation governance.

If upstream state changes, reliance eligibility must respond.

Reliance Eligibility Does Not Override Risk Governance

A Reliance Eligible outcome does not require an organization to accept the operational risk.

Risk governance may still reject the use.

Reliance Eligibility Does Not Override Law

Likewise, VRESM does not establish legal permission.

A methodologically eligible reliance may still be prohibited by law or regulation.

Reliance Eligibility Does Not Guarantee Outcome

VALIDOS® establishes:

Reliance Eligible ≠ Outcome Guaranteed

Eligibility means the validation basis is methodologically sufficient for the assessed reliance context.

It does not eliminate uncertainty or failure.

Machine-Readable Reliance Eligibility

VRESM may support machine-readable representations such as:

Validation State: Validated

Object Match: Yes Purpose Match: Yes

Scope Match: Yes

Conditions: Satisfied

Validation Depth: Sufficient

Revalidation Required: No

Reliance Eligibility: Eligible

This could enable automated validation-reliance gates.

Automated Eligibility Assessment

Where criteria are sufficiently explicit, software may automatically assess:

- object version,
- scope,
- expiration,
- conditions,
- restrictions,
- environment,
- and other structured variables.

Automation should preserve the underlying assessment logic.

AI-Assisted Eligibility Assessment

AI may assist with:

- context comparison,
- purpose matching,
- scope interpretation,
- limitation analysis,
- consequence classification,
- validation-record synthesis,
- and potential mismatch identification.

AI assistance should not silently expand Validation State applicability.

Human Eligibility Assessment

Human judgment may remain necessary where:

- context is ambiguous,
- consequence is difficult to classify,
- validation limitations require interpretation,
- purpose is novel,

- or applicability boundaries are uncertain.

Human conclusions should remain traceable to the validation basis.

Reliance Eligibility Record

A formal Reliance Eligibility Record may preserve:

- Relying Actor,
- Validation Object,
- object version,
- current Validation State,
- Reliance Purpose,
- Reliance Scope,
- Reliance Context,
- consequence,
- criticality,
- purpose match,
- scope match,
- object match,
- population match,
- environment match,
- operational-mode match,
- autonomy match,
- Validation Depth sufficiency,
- evidence sufficiency,
- Source Reliability relevance,
- uncertainty sufficiency,
- state conditions,
- restrictions,
- limitations,
- state currency,
- Revalidation Required status,
- Eligibility Status,
- eligibility conditions,
- assessment time,
- and sufficient traceability.

Minimum Implementation Framework

1. Identify the Relying Actor

Establish who or what intends to rely upon the Validation State.

2. Identify the Validation Object

Confirm object identity, version, and relevant configuration.

3. Establish Current Validation State

Retrieve the applicable current state from VSGS.

4. Define Reliance Purpose

Identify why validation is being relied upon.

5. Define Reliance Scope

Establish intended function, population, environment, jurisdiction, mode, autonomy, duration, and other relevant boundaries.

6. Establish Reliance Context

Define the operational conditions surrounding reliance.

7. Assess Reliance Consequence

Determine the significance of reliance failure and required validation assurance.

8. Perform Applicability Matching

Compare intended reliance with:

- Validation Object,
- State Applicability Profile,
- purpose,
- scope,
- population,
- environment,
- jurisdiction,
- mode,
- autonomy,
- conditions,
- restrictions,
- and time.

9. Assess Validation Sufficiency

Evaluate:

- Validation Depth,
- evidence,
- sources,
- uncertainty,
- limitations,
- and state currency

relative to the intended reliance.

10. Identify Critical Deficiencies

Determine whether any failed dimension independently prevents reliance.

11. Assign Reliance Eligibility Status

Establish:

- Eligible,
- Conditionally Eligible,
- Partially Eligible,
- Undetermined,
- or Not Eligible.

12. Preserve Eligibility Traceability

Maintain the complete basis supporting the Eligibility Status and its boundaries.

Governance Outputs

VRESM may produce:

- Relying Actor Record,
- Reliance Purpose Record,
- Reliance Scope Record,
- Reliance Context Record,
- Reliance Consequence Assessment,
- Reliance Criticality Classification,
- Object Identity Match Assessment,
- Object Version Match Assessment,
- Configuration Match Assessment,
- Purpose Match Assessment,
- Scope Match Assessment,
- Population Match Assessment,
- Environment Match Assessment,
- Jurisdiction Match Assessment,
- Operational Mode Match Assessment,
- Autonomy-Level Match Assessment,
- Validation State Applicability Match,
- Validation Depth Sufficiency Assessment,
- Evidence Sufficiency for Reliance Assessment,
- Source Sufficiency Assessment,
- Uncertainty Sufficiency Assessment,
- Condition Compatibility Assessment,
- Restriction Compatibility Assessment,
- Reliance Limitation Assessment,
- Reliance Sufficiency Profile,
- Critical Reliance Deficiency Record,
- Validation Depth Escalation Requirement,
- Reliance Eligibility Status,
- Reliance Eligibility Record,
- and Eligibility Reassessment Trigger.

Use Case 1 — AI Decision Support vs Autonomous Decision

Scenario

An AI model holds:

Validation State: Validated

Its validated purpose is:

Professional Decision Support with Human Review

An organization wants the same model to make final decisions automatically.

Application

VRESM identifies:

Object Match: Full

Version Match: Full

Purpose Match: Mismatch

Autonomy-Level Match: Mismatch

Human Oversight Condition: Not Satisfied

Result

Reliance Not Eligible

The model remains Validated for its original purpose.

VALIDOS® does not falsely convert the proposed autonomous use into an invalidation of the entire model.

Use Case 2 — Healthcare AI Population Expansion

Scenario

A diagnostic AI is Validated for adults.

A hospital proposes using it for pediatric patients.

Application

VRESM identifies:

Purpose Match: Full

Object Match: Full

Population Match: Outside Validation

Result

Reliance Not Eligible — Pediatric Population

while adult reliance may remain eligible.

A targeted or partial revalidation pathway may later assess the new population.

Use Case 3 — Low-Consequence to Critical Reliance

Scenario

A predictive model was Validated at a moderate Validation Depth for internal strategic planning.

The same organization proposes using it as the primary automated trigger for a high-value financial transaction.

Application

VRESM identifies:

Object Match: Full

Purpose Match: Partial

Reliance Consequence: High

Validation Depth: Insufficient for Proposed Reliance

Result

The current Validation State remains legitimate for its existing scope.

However:

Reliance Not Eligible for Proposed Critical Use

and: **Validation Depth Escalation Required**

may be generated.

Architectural Position

Validation Reliance Eligibility & Sufficiency is the first internal governance space of the **Validation Reliance & Revalidation Standard (VRRS).**

It establishes the transition:

Current Validation State

↓

Specific Reliance Context

↓

Reliance Sufficiency

↓

Reliance Eligibility

The remaining VRRS modules can then govern:

Module 2 — Reliance Conditions, Authorization & Operational Control

How eligible reliance becomes governed operational reliance.

Module 3 — Reliance Monitoring, Dependency & Change Propagation

How reliance remains connected to changes in upstream validation and downstream dependency.

Module 4 — Revalidation Scope, Delta & Validation Reuse

How a revalidation trigger is translated into proportionate revalidation rather than unnecessary complete repetition.

Module 5 — Revalidation Execution, Renewal & Reliance Continuity

How revalidation returns through VALIDOS®, creates a new determination and state, and renews, modifies, restricts, suspends, or terminates reliance.

The complete VRRS progression therefore becomes:

Reliance Eligibility & Sufficiency → Reliance Conditions & Authorization → Reliance Monitoring & Change Propagation → Revalidation Scope & Delta → Revalidation Execution & Renewal

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Foundational Principle

A Validation State should support reliance only when the object, purpose, scope, context, consequence, conditions, and assurance required by that reliance remain within what the validation basis can legitimately support.

Canonical Closing Statement

Validation Reliance Eligibility & Sufficiency Module establishes the first operational reliance gate of VALIDOS® by determining whether a

current Validation State is sufficiently applicable and proportionate to support a specific Relying Actor, purpose, scope, context, consequence, and operational use. Through object and version matching, purpose and scope alignment, population and environment applicability, autonomy and operational-mode matching, Validation Depth sufficiency, evidence and source relevance, uncertainty assessment, condition and restriction compatibility, state currency, critical-deficiency detection, and context-bound Reliance Eligibility classification, VRESM prevents validation from becoming unrestricted permission and ensures that every transition from Validation State to operational reliance begins with an explicit methodological determination that the validation basis actually supports the use for which it is about to be relied upon.

Parent Resources

→ VALIDOS® Validation Governance Architecture — Validation Governance Layer

→ VALIDOS® Architecture Map

→ VALIDOS® Complete Standards & Modules Index

Internal Module Flow

→ Next module: Validation Reliance Conditions, Authorization & Operational Control Module (VRCAOCM)

Related Documents

→ Validation Reliance & Revalidation Standard

→ About Validation Reliance & Revalidation Standard

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Canonical Source

https://originopenfoundation.org/